ROBERT L. HOWARD
SHERIFF

EDWARD R. MIKULA
UNDERSHERIFF

OFFICE OF
THE SHERIFF OF TOMPKINS COUNTY
125 EAST COURT STREET
ITHACA, N.Y. 14850

August 1, 1986

Mr. Tom Joyce
109 W. State Street
Ithaca, New York 14850

Dear Tom,

The Sheriff of any County has the responsiblity of protection of people involved in a labor strike.

Our involvement at Cargill is for the protection of all involved, the striking miners, staff and management of the mine. We are not allowed to take sides in the issues. We fully realize we are involved in a no win situation for us but will do our upmost to perform the duties in a fair and impartial manner as the law directs.

We can not guarantee the safety of pickets who walk out in front of trucks, lay across hoods of moving vehicles, etc. Loaded trucks should not be stopped coming out of the mine as they might loose control and run away backward down the hill. Pickets should not block the highway regardless of their union affiliations.

If everyone uses some common sense, we will be able to do our job. The deputies do understand their obligations and will arrest anyone who violates the law be it Cargill people or pickets.

Sincerely,

Robert L. Howard

Robert L. Howard
Tompkins County Sheriff

RLH/jrm